

The story of KRYPTOS has been unfolding for almost 20 years at the Central Intelligence Agency Headquarters in Langley, Virginia. Dedicated in 1990, this art installation consists of multiple elements.

Three granite outcroppings, copper plates, a lodestone and a compass dial are installed as one approaches the New Headquarters Building. The copper plates contain an encoded text in a simple coding system – International Morse. Elements of increasing complexity are located in the Agency's inner courtyard. A granite outcropping, aligned with and parallel to the entrance outcroppings, sits adjacent to a large, calm pool of water. The most prominent and enigmatic element in the courtyard is a 10' tall by 20' wide serpentine copper screen framed by a petrified tree and a turbulent pool of water. This screen is perforated with an encrypted message and decoding chart – a modified Vigenéries Tableaux.

2010 marks the 20th anniversary of the dedication of KRYPTOS. This highly accurate scale model of the KRYPTOS screen commemorates that landmark. The model, made of nickel silver, darkens naturally with age.

Ace code-breakers worldwide have yet to crack the final coded section of the screen, known infamously as "K4". An understanding of this scale model and the entire KRYPTOS ensemble is essential to cracking the codes. Please enjoy the challenge!

Best of luck,

Jim Sanborn

Hey Jumpy! 
Hey Slanny!
Hey Randy!
Hey SIGBE!
All the best 